

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards. In the background, there are four cards: a red heart, a black club, a red diamond, and a black spade. In the foreground, a fan of cards is displayed, showing ranks from Ace down to 8 in various suits. The cards are arranged in a fan shape, with the Ace of Clubs on the left and the 8 of Spades on the right. The suits include Hearts, Clubs, Diamonds, and Spades.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6 

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6 

Declarer: East

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6



♠ 8 6 2

♥ K J 8 5 3 2

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			
6♦ by North			

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2

♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3



♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ -

♣ A K Q 7

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♣

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East
good idea so you say 6♥.

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a